A-A-550A
November 18, 1982
SUPERSEDING
A-A-550
September 27, 1979

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BAGS, PAPER (GROCER'S)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to type I and type II of Federal Specification UU-B-36.

This description covers the requirements of kraft paper grocery bags of standard commercial sizes, weights of paper, and types of construction.

Salient characteristics.

Materials used in the production of grocer's bags shall conform to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The paper shall be sized; self-opening style bags shall be type I; and, square style bags shall be type II. The bags shall be fabricated from two grades of paper, grade A popular weight and grade B heavy weight. The paper shall conform to the requirements as shown in table I. The bag number, type, grade, and construction shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Sizing test. A specimen of kraft bag paper shall be placed on a flat, dry and clean surface. A drop of water (approximately 0.1 cubic centemeter) shall be dropped on the specimen from a height of not more than 3 inches. A watch glass shall be placed over the drop of water immediately after contact with the paper. After 20 minutes the area of the paper contracted by drop shall show partial retention of the drop as evidenced by reflectivity.

Test shall be performed for basis weight in accordance with TAPPI T410, bursting strength T403, and tear resistance T414. Acceptance shall be based on an AQL of 4. 0 in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

FSC 8105

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TABLE I

Bag Number	Minimum capacity (tolerance minus 2% unlimited plus) (cubic inches)	Grade A paper, popular weight: Basis wt. 24x36-500 (tolerance minus 5% unlimited plus) (pounds)	Grade A paper, popular weight: Average bursting strength, minimum (points)	Grade A paper, popular weight: Average tearing resistance machine direction, minimum (grams)	Grade B paper, heavy weight: Basis wt. 24x36-500 (tolerance minus 5% unlimited plus (pounds)	Grade B paper, heavy weight: Average bursting strength, minimum (points)	Grade B paper, heavy weight: Average tearing resistance machine direction, minimum (grams)
1/2	30	30	15	38			
1	51	30	15	38			
2	83	30	15	38			
3	119	30	15	38			
4	151	30	15	38			
5	191	35	18	50	50	29	86
6	240	35	18	50			
8 2/	304	35	18	50			
10	350	35	18	50	60	36	110
12	433	40	22	63	60	36	110
16	593	40	22	63	60	36	110
20	700	40	22	63	60	36	110
25	779	40	22	63	60	36	110
1/8 2/	973	50	29	86	60	36	110
1/6 2/	1386	50	29	86	60	36	110
1/6 2/,3/	1386	2/40	22	63			
duplex	1386	2/50	29	86			
1/6 2/	1428	60					
special	or		36	110	70	41	130
1/4 2/	1782	60	36	110	70	41	130
1/6	1386				75	46	137
					80	50	150

2/ Type I, self-opening bag only

3/ Duplex construction consisting of two walls of paper as specified with each wall having basis weight, burst, and tear values as shown.

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Dimensions for all types I and II bags shall be as shown in table II below, as a guide only, and to determine capacity.

TABLE II

Bag Number	Type I, self-opening bags: Face (A) Width	Bottom (C) Width	Bag (D) Length	Type II, square bags: Face (A) Width	Tuck (C) Width	Bag (D) Length
	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches
1/2	3	1-3/4	5-7/8	3	1-3/4	6-1/2
1	3-1/2	2-1/8	6-3/4	3-3/8	2-1/4	7-3/4
2	4-1/4	2-3/8	8-1/8	4	2-5/8	9-1/4
3	4-3/4	2-7/8	8-3/4	4-3/4	3-1/8	10-1/8
4	5	3-1/8	9-3/4	5	3-1/4	11-1/4
5	5-1/4	3-3/8	10-3/4	5-1/4	3-3/8	12-1/2
6	6	3-3/4	11	5-3/4	3-7/8	12-3/4
8	6-1/4	3-3/4	12-3/4			
10	6-1/2	4-1/8	13-1/8	6-1/4	4-3/8	15
12	7	4-1/2	13-7/8	6-78	4-5/8	16
16	7-5/8	4-7/8	16	7-1/4	5-1/4	18-1/8
20	8-1/8	6	14-3/8			
20	8-1/4	5-1/4	16-1/4	8-1/8	5-1/2	18-1/2
25	8-1/8	6	16			
25	8-1/4	5-1/4	17-7/8	8-1/8	5-1/2	20-3/8
1/8	9-3/4	6-1/4	16-3/8			
1/6	11	7	18-1/4			
1/6 duplex or	11	7	18-1/4			
1/6 duplex	12	7	17			
1/6 special	12	7	17			
1/6 special	11-1/2	7	17-1/2			
1/4	11	7	23-1/4			

Each bag shall be marked with the appropriate bag number shown in column I of tables I and II, as applicable, as part of the manufacturer's trademark or imprint (IDENTIFICATION).

The issue of each TAPPI methods in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with these requirements.

Cubic capacity. Method of measuring the bags and computing capacity (see figures 1 and 2).

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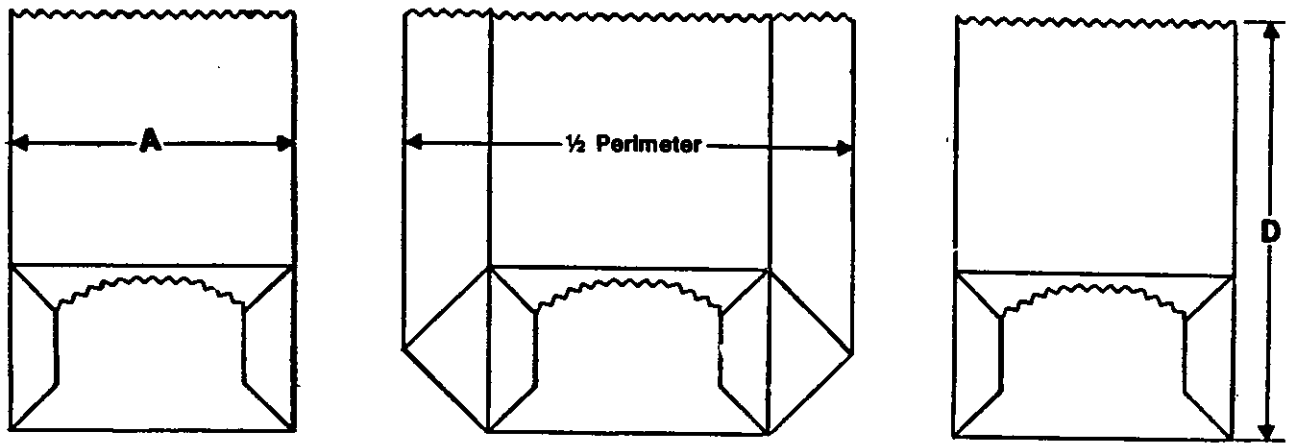


FIGURE I. Method of measuring self-opening (automatic) bags

Face width (A): Measure across the front of the folded bag just above the top of the bottom fold as shown in figure 1.

Bottom width (C): Spread the bag so that the tucks normally behind the face are fully extended outward. Press the bag flat and measure full width as close to the bottom fold as possible. This gives one-half perimeter. Substracting the face width (A) from this measurement gives dimension (C).

Bag length (D): Measure along center of the front face of the bag from the lower bottom fold to the top of the serrated edge.

Cubic capacity is the product of the face width, bottom width, and bag length: AXCXD.

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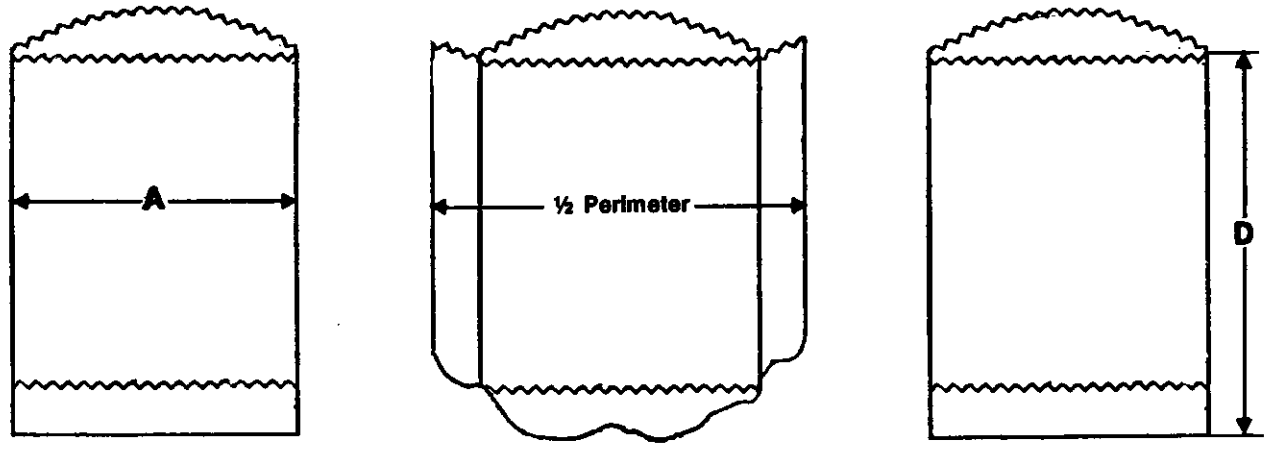


FIGURE 2. Method of measuring square bags

Face width (A): Measure across the front of the folded bag just above the top of the bottom fold as shown in figure 2.

Tuck width (C): Spread the bag so that the tucks normally behind the face are fully extended outward. Press the bag flat and measure full width as close to the bottom fold as possible. This gives one-half perimeter. Subtracting the face width (A) from this measurement gives dimension (C), the tuck width.

Bag length (D): Measure along center of the front face of the bag, from the lower bottom fold to the top of the serrated edge of the front face.

Cubic capacity is the product of the face width, tuck width, and the bag length minus one-half the tuck width: AXCXD—1/2 C).

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Workmanship. Bags shall be uniformly constructed, free from holes, tears, cuts, or splits. All seams shall adhere securely throughout their area.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Note: Purchasers shall specify type, grade, dimensions and bag number (size).

TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 69

Reviewing Activities

Army - MD
Air Force - 99

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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